

# Before you change bank details

Pause a payment to a supplier you have not paid before, or one using changed bank details until your own checks are done.

## 1. Check your own records

Is this an expected invoice for goods or work your business agreed to buy? Compare the supplier, amount, reference and payment details with your trusted records. A familiar logo or correct email address is not proof.

## 2. Make the call yourself

When paying a supplier you have not paid before, or changing bank details, call the supplier using a trusted number you already held before this request. Do not use a number or link supplied in the request. An incoming call, even with a familiar caller ID, is not independent confirmation.

## 3. Confirm the details on that call

Ask your known supplier contact to read back the account name, sort code and account number through your approved process. Compare them privately with the request. Do not type them into this checklist. If the supplier is busy, arrange to call them back yourself.

## 4. Follow your payment approval process

Record who made the checks, when, which trusted contact route was used and any difference in your own protected records. Use any second-person approval your business requires. If a bank name check does not match, stop and resolve it. A match alone does not prove the request is genuine.

## If you cannot verify the request

Keep the payment on hold and tell your business owner or payment lead. No deadline, genuine sender account, incoming callback or bank name match removes the need for independent checks.

This aid records steps you say you took. It does not inspect the invoice, verify a person or account, authorise a payment or guarantee that fraud is absent. A genuine email account or a check of an email's technical information cannot prove that a payment request is genuine.

# A record for your own files

Copy this blank record for each request to pay a supplier you have not paid before or to change bank details. Keep it in your approved, protected business records, not in a shared public folder. Do not write full bank details or unnecessary personal information here.

Supplier and invoice reference

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Date request received / amount

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Expected purchase checked against

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Person carrying out checks / date and time

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Trusted contact route used / where held before this request

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Contact reached / what they confirmed (no full bank details)

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Differences or missing checks / action taken

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Approval required / authorised decision-maker

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Decision, reason and date / follow-up owner

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## A call script

I am calling on the number we already hold to check a payment request. Did you send it? Please confirm the invoice reference and amount, and read back the payment details through our agreed process. We will keep it on hold until our checks and approval are done.

# When a check stops the payment

Fictional example, not a real customer

A two-person repair business receives an expected supplier invoice. The email asks it to use a different bank account, and the email address looks right. The owner calls the number saved in the supplier record before this request. The supplier says it did not change its payment details. The owner keeps the payment on hold, saves the request and tells the payment lead. A familiar sender account did not settle whether the request was genuine. No payment has been sent, so the owner has no recovery to claim.

## If money was already sent

If money may already have gone to a fraudster, contact your bank immediately using its official app or a trusted number, such as the one on your card or statement. Ask about stopping or recovering the payment; recovery is not guaranteed. Tell your business owner or payment lead and preserve the request and payment records. In England, Wales or Northern Ireland, report fraud to Report Fraud. In Scotland, report to Police Scotland on 101. If accounts or personal data may also be affected, follow your incident plan and current official guidance.

## Using the browser checklist

Open [payment-check.html](#) in a browser. It needs no sign-in or connection to read and use the checks. Do not enter bank details; there are no text fields. Choices are held only in the page, not saved. Reloading, closing or Reset answers clears them. Print uses your browser and may put a copy into your chosen PDF or printer. Source links open external sites when selected. The page cannot decide that a payment is safe.

## Sources and limits

Sources checked 7 October 2026. General guidance, not legal or financial advice. Not endorsed by cited organisations. Follow your bank's current guidance, your payment controls and official incident-reporting guidance. No fraud prevention or recovery guarantee.

Take Five: invoice and mandate fraud

<https://www.takefive-stopfraud.org.uk/protect-your-business/invoice-and-mandate/>

Barclays: verbal checks and bank name-match limits

<https://www.barclayscorporate.com/fraud-protection/payee-verification-campaign-Q126/>

British Business Bank: invoice checks

<https://www.british-business-bank.co.uk/business-guidance/guidance-articles/business-essentials/how-to-avoid-invoice-fraud>

Report Fraud: England, Wales and Northern Ireland

<https://reportfraud.police.uk/>

Police Scotland: business fraud

<https://www.scotland.police.uk/advice-and-information/scams-and-frauds/business-fraud>